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Oakleaf Partnership & Weil

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Oakleaf Partnership

A market-leading boutique HR recruitment and executive search business.

We combine deep subject matter and market expertise, gained over 21 years of successful delivery in partnership with a global client base across multiple industry sectors.

With offices in the UK and the USA, our consultants have deep, holistic knowledge of their sectors and the talent pools that lie within them

Critically, we care deeply about the customers we serve and the relationships we build over the years, on a foundation of trust, confidentiality and delivery.

HR Market

UK HR hiring showed early signs of recovery across July to September 2026, our second fiscal quarter.

The Indeed Hiring Lab index of HR postings closed the quarter a little higher after a **10.9%** spring fall, and permanent placements grew for the first time in nearly four years.

The growth is marginal and the wider market still soft, but the direction has changed.

+2.5%

UK HR postings, July to September

+22.4%

New HR postings, July to September

50.9

Permanent placements index, September

HR Market Update: July to September 2026, UK HR hiring shows early signs of recovery

Perm or Contracting?

Permanent role

Ongoing employment and potential longer-term development

Responsibilities, benefits, and progression

Interim assignment

A defined role addressing an immediate need

Deliverables, duration, start date, and extension terms

Contract role

Project-based or specialist work

Make your CV tell the right story

1. Target role or professional headline
2. Short profile linking your experience to your next step
3. Relevant skills, backed up by examples
4. Work history with achievements and outcomes
5. Education, qualifications, and relevant training

What you did
+ the challenge or scope
+ the result

Interview Prep:

Competency Based IV's

STAR STRUCTURE:

S

Situation

(what was happening)

T

Task

(what were you responsible for?)

A

Action

(what did you do?)

R

Result

(what changed?)

Salary Benchmarking

1. Compare roles with similar responsibilities, experience, and location.
2. Check several current sources, such as salary surveys, job postings, and recruiter insights.
3. Consider the full package, not only base salary, including bonus, benefits, pension or retirement contributions, leave, and contract terms.
4. Decide what range and overall package you would consider before the conversation

RECRUITERS

How can we help?

LinkedIn

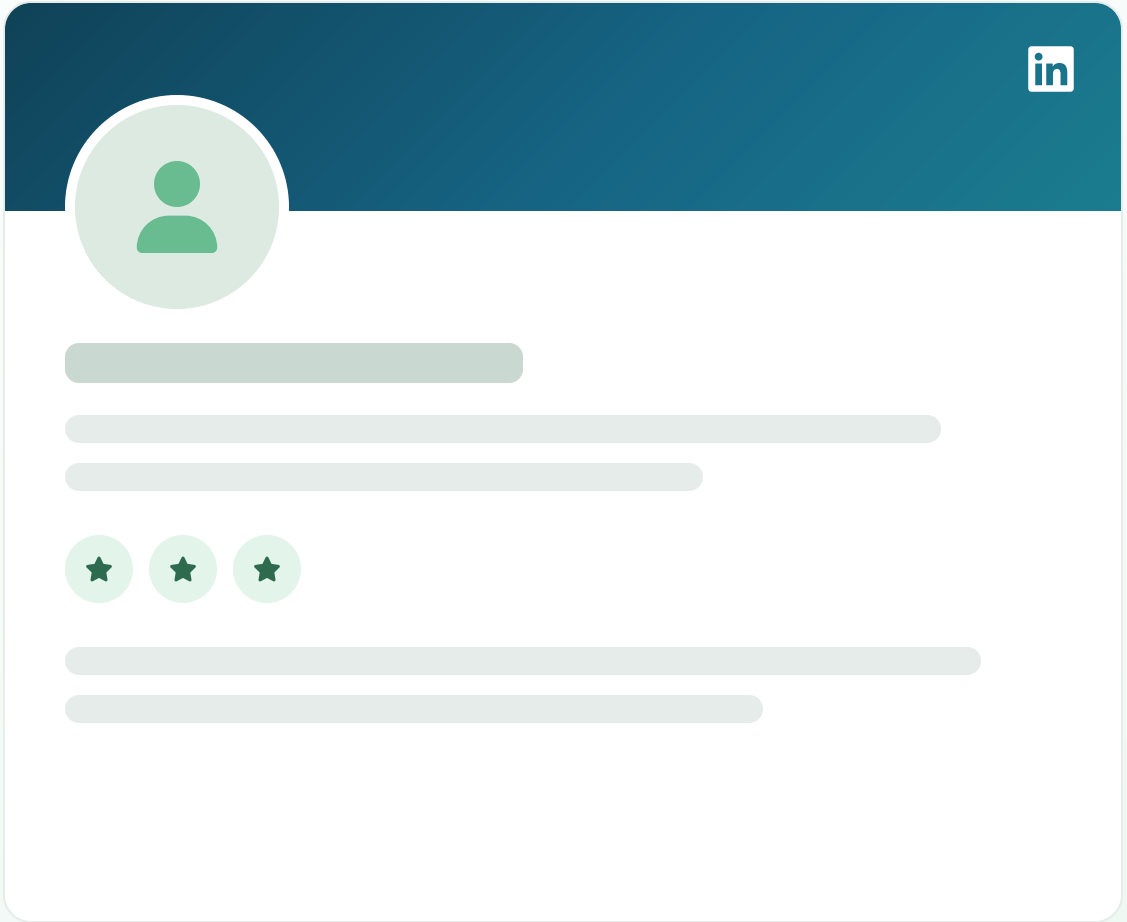
Use LinkedIn to help get recognised in the market:

Your profile should be easy for other people to understand

Headline formula:

Target function | Key strengths | Relevant experience or sector

Recommendations!



Q&A